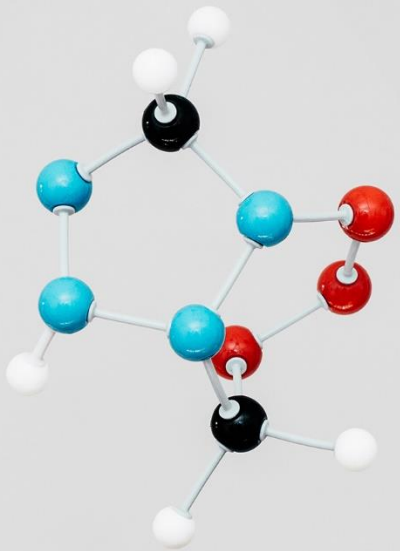


GRAMMAR & BASICS

Session 1

Tenses

Wooclap

Course Set-up

Two sessions per week

1) Lecture

Lectures with stem-group:
explanation, discussion and practice of a grammatical topic

2) Work sessions (leerplein).

Work sessions with all groups:

you can work on self-study topics, ask teachers questions about that week's topics, work on speaking (get feedback) or on writing/culture assignments.

Grammatical Tenses

We use grammatical tenses to describe when an ACTION happened.

Three main tenses:

Past, Present, Future

Rest of the grammatical tenses are aspects of these three main tenses

Today we focus on:

The Present & The Past

Present Tenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

Present Simple (3 types)

- It **rains** a lot in the Netherlands.
- The train **leaves** tonight at 10 PM.
- He **works** hard most of the time.
- They **play** tennis.
- Water **freezes** at 0 degrees Celsius.

Present Continuous (4 types)

- Close the door! It **is freezing** outside.
- I **am staying** with some friends until I find a flat.
- Shh! I **am reading** my book.
- I **am reading** The Lord of the Rings for the third time.
- I **am meeting** some friends after work.
- She **is** always **yelling** in class.

Present simple – Usage I

- Repeated actions
  - The train **leaves** every morning at 8 AM.
  - I **go** to the climbing gym every Sunday.
- Facts or Generalizations
  - Water **boils** at 100 degrees celsius.
  - Dogs **like** playing fetch.
- Scheduled events int he near future
  - When **does** class **begin** tomorrow?
  - The party **starts** at 8 o'clock.

Present simple – Usage II

- I **go** to school <u>every day</u>.
- She <u>usually</u> **reads** a book after dinner.

Signal words: every.., each, usually, every day,

Present Simple

Form:

I, you, we, they + verb → I work

he, she, it + verb + -s → he work**s**

Exceptions

- do and go: verb + -es →

  he **does**, he **goes**

- verbs ending in -s/-ss/-sh/-ch/x: verb + -es →

  he **kisses**, he **washes**, he **boxes**

- verbs ending in -y: -y → -ies →

  he **hurries**, he **studies**, he **tries**

- But -ay/-ey/-oy/-uy just get -s →

  he **plays**, he **enjoys**, he **buys**

Present continuous – Usage

- Now
  - You are learning English now.
  - He is running now.
- Longer actions in progress now
  - Trump is running for president.
  - I am reading Dune.
- Near Future
  - I am cycling to work tomorrow.
  - They are looking after the baby next weekend.
- Repetition and irritation with *always*
  - He is always stomping down the stairs.
  - She is always eating with her mouth open.

Present Continuous

Form:

- I + <u>am</u> + verb + -ing → I **am working**
- he, she, it + <u>is</u> + verb + -ing → he **is working**
- you, we, they + <u>are</u> + verb + -ing → you **are working**

Present Continuous - Spelling

- Verbs ending in -ie (die, lie, tie): -ie → y →

  I **am dying**, you **are lying**, he **is tying**
- Verbs ending in vowel + consonant (stop, plan, rub) double the consonant →

  I **am stopping**, you **are planning**, he **is rubbing**
- verbs ending in -e (hope, dance, smile): leave out -e

  I **am hoping**, you **are dancing**, he **is smiling**

Present continuous – signal words

- Words indicating a current action:
  - (right) now, at the moment, look!, listen!

- Words indicating a period around now:
  - today, this week, this year

Present Tenses Compared

Present Simple Rule

- Facts and routines
- Verb
- Verb+S
- Verb+ES

Present Continuous Rule

- Action at the moment, in progress, unfinished
- Am, is, are + Verb+ING

Individual Practice

See worksheet(s) on Teams

Practice! - Pairs

- **Describe** an average day in your life Using the PRESENT SIMPLE only

Signal words:

- Always
- Every…
- Normally
- Sometimes
- Regularly
- Never
- Often

BREAK

Present/Past Tenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

Past Simple (4 types)

- I **lived** in Groningen for 8 years.
- They **played** the violin as a child.
- It **was** at school last week.
- He **painted** the door last week.
- She **broke** her leg when she was 12.
- First I **woke** up, then I **had** breakfast, and then I **cycled** to school.

Present Perfect (2 types)

- I **have lived** in Utrecht for 6 years.
- I **have been** at school since this morning.
- I **have** already **seen** Dune, but I'd still like to go to the movies.
- He **has painted** the door, so don't touch it.
- She **has broken** her leg and can't walk for a while

Past Simple - Usage

- Completed Action in the past
  - I saw a movie yesterday
  - That car looks dirty. Yeah, the last time I cleaned it was 4 months ago.
- Series of actions
  - I finished work, walked to the beach, and found a nice place to swim.
- Duration in the past
  - We waited for 5 hours.
- Habit in the past (used to)
  - I studied Japanese when I was younger.

Present Perfect - Usage

- Unspecified Time before now
  - I **have been** to Japan before
  - Ooow, you **have grown** so much since I last saw you.
  - Samir **hasn't arrived** yet.
  - They **have** already **scored** 3 goals and it's only half-time!
- Duration from the past until now (and possibly continuing)
  - He has been ill for a week.
  - I have backpacked around Spain for a month now.

Present/Past Tenses Compared

Past Simple Rule

- **Completed** action in past
- Verb+ed
- Irregular form of verb

Present Perfect Rule

- Action started in past and **noticable/still happening** now
- Have/has + past participle

Past simple - Spelling

The verbs that are regular sometimes also have changes in spelling

- Verbs ending in vowel + consonant (stop, plan, rub) double the consonant →

  I **stopped**, you **planned**, he **rubbed**
- verbs ending in -e (hope, dance, smile): just add -d

  he **hoped**, he **danced**, he **smiled**
- verbs ending in -y: -y → -ied →

  he **hurried**, he **studied**, he **tried**
- But: he **played**, he **enjoyed**

Past simple - When

- When there is an expression **indicating past time**
  - I **worked** at Hogeschool Rotterdam five years ago.
  - They **went** to school yesterday.
  - Shakespeare **died** in 1616.
  - I **saw** John 5 minutes ago.

- To indicate that something is finished.
  - I **lived** in Groningen for 8 years.
  - He **worked** at that office for a couple of months.

Past simple – Signal words

- Any expression indicating past time
  - Yesterday, earlier, … ago, last …, in (+ time in the past), when …, specific dates

Present Perfect – When I

- I **have worked** at Hogeschool Utrecht <u>for four years now.</u>
- He **has lived** in the Netherlands <u>all his life.</u>

Form:

- I you, we, they + <u>have</u> + verb + -ed → I have worked
- he, she, it + <u>has</u> + verb + -ed → he has worked
- The spelling difficulties are the same as for the past forms (see slide 4)

Present Perfect – When II

- Anything from the past until now that is not finished
  - I **have lived** in Utrecht for 6 years.
  - He **has** never **been** to Spain.

- Also actions in the past that have a result now
  - I **have forgotten** her name (I still don't remember it now).
  - She **has lost** her key (she still doesn't have it now).

- But: when the action is over and/or a time expression is used you use the past form
  - She **lost** her key, but she found it again.
  - She **lost** her key yesterday.

Irregular forms

- See book – Appendix list

Present Perfect – Signal words

- Words indicating how long:
  - Since (+ moment in time) → since Monday, since June
  - For (+ duration) → for weeks, for 5 years
    - Only if it has not finished!
  - They lived there for 5 years, but then they moved away.

Past tenses - Review

- We've already seen two forms to talk about the past
  - For things that are finished (past only) →
    I worked there for 4 years
  - For things that are not finished (from past until now) →
    I have worked there for 4 years
- There are two other forms that are used, especially in combination with the normal past form

Individual Practice

See worksheet(s) on Teams

Task: Introduce Yourself

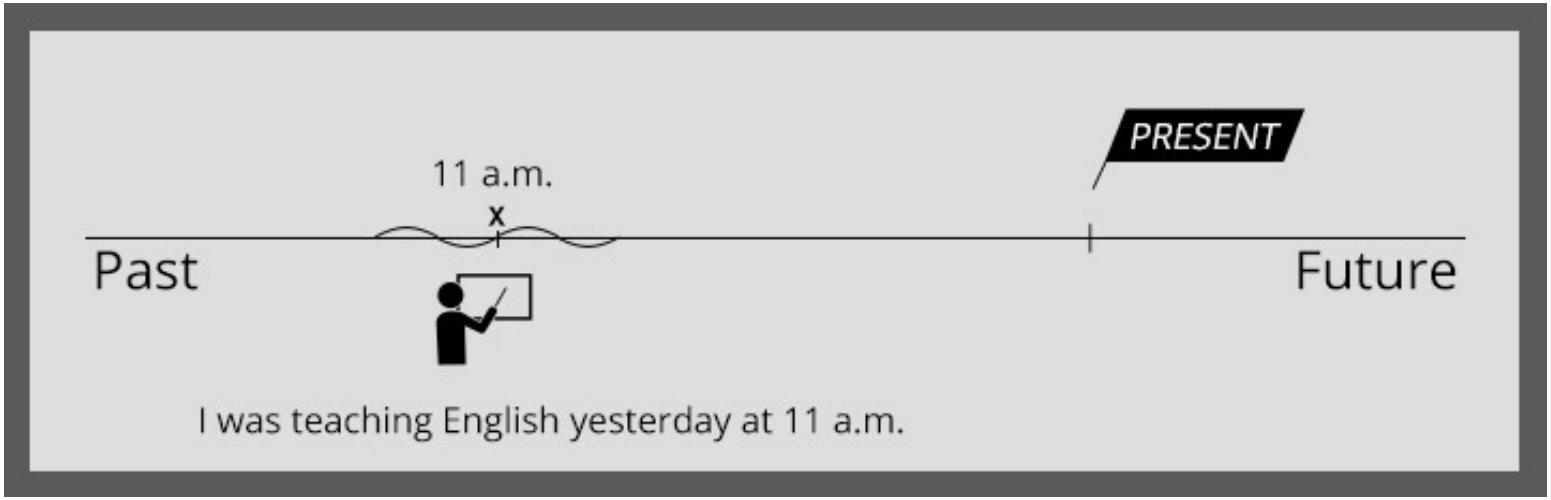
Create a Youtube short/Instagram post/Tik-Tok/Reddit post/etc. in which you introduce yourself to me and the rest of the class.

Upload it in the Teams folder named 'Introductions'.

- 45 seconds to 1 minute long
- Use at least the following tenses intentionally using different verbs:
  - 4x present simple
  - 4x present continuous
  - 4x past simple
  - 4x present perfect
- For inspiration on what to talk/write about, look at the tenses!

Past Tenses Compared

Past Continuous



Past Tenses Compared

Past Perfect

Two things happening in the past

One after another

- Sometimes one event happens after another.
  - After I **had left**, he **arrived**.
  - I **had called** her before I **heard** she wasn't home.
- The event that happened first gets another form:

- I, you, he, she, it, we, they + <u>had</u> + verb + ed → I had worked
- See spelling rules/difficulties
- Also many irregular forms (3rd column) → I had done

Two things happening in the past

One after another

- Often words like ‘before’ and ‘after’ also indicate the order
  - After I **had left**, he **arrived**.
  - I **had called** her before I **heard** she wasn’t home.
- Not always the same order as the sentence
  - Before I **found** the ticket, the show **had** already **begun**

Two things happening in the past

One after another

- Sometimes you can only tell from the verb form which happened first
  - When the police arrived the thieves **had left** the building

    (= the thieves had left before the police arrived)
  - When the police arrived the thieves **left** the building

    (= the thieves left right before the police arrived)

Two things happening in the past

At the same time

- Sometimes two things in the past happened at the same time
- Often one longer action interrupted by a shorter action
  - While I **was having** a bath the phone **rang.**
  - I **was cutting** the grass when suddenly I **hurt** my back.
- You can also use them the other way around
  - When I **saw** Mike I **was cycling** home.

Longer actions in the past

Form:

- I, he, she, it + <u>was</u> + verb + -ing → I was working
- you, we, they + <u>were</u> + verb + -ing → you were working

Longer actions in the past

- Besides using a phrase like ‘when I saw Mike’ we can also use expressions that indicate a time in the past
  - At 5 o’clock I **was cycling** home
  - Yesterday evening I **was watching** TV.
- The form indicates that at that time you were in the middle of an action

Past Tenses Compared

Past Continuous

- Long action in the past interrupted by a short action in the past
- Continuous actions in the past
- Was/were + verb+ ing

Past Perfect

- One action in past before another action in the past
- Had + past participle

TENSES SESSION 2

The Future

Future tenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

I **will travel** to New York some day.
I **am going to travel to** New York this summer.
I **am travelling** to New York tomorrow.
My plane **leaves** at 15:00.

Future tenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

I **will travel** to New York some day.	Prediction, neutral attitude
I **am going to travel to** New York this summer.	Plan, intention
I **am travelling** to New York tomorrow.	Arrangement
My plane **leaves** at 15:00.	Fixed in a timetable

Future tenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

I **will travel** to New York some day.	Prediction, neutral attitude	Rule: will+ verb
I **am going to travel to** New York this summer.	Plan, intention	Rule: am/is/are going to + verb
I **am travelling** to New York tomorrow.	Arrangement	Rule: Am / is/ are verb+ing
My plane **leaves** at 15:00.	Fixed in a timetable	Rule: Verb+(ES)(S)

Talking about the future

- In Dutch we often use the present form to talk about the future
- In English you need to use a future form
- The most common form is:

- I/you/he/she/it/we/they + **will** + verb → I will work

FutureTenses Compared

What is the difference in meaning?

- Oh, I**'ll buy** some chocolate on my way there.
- (I think/I hope) I**'ll have** so much fun this weekend.
- I think he**'ll fail.**
- I**'m going to buy** some chocolate on my way there.
- I**'m going to have** so much fun this weekend.
- He didn't study. He**'s going to fail**.

Will is used

- As a neutral way to talk about the future
  - We **will** meet again next week.
  - I **will** see you later.
- For predictions
  - (I think) Hillary Clinton **will** run for president.
  - Tomorrow **will** be rainy.
- For decisions made at the moment of speaking
  - [phone ringing] I **will** get it.
  - John called. Ok, I **will** call him back.

Talking about the future

- Another common way to talk about the future is the following form:

- I <u>am</u> **going to** + verb → I am going to do
- he, she, it <u>is</u> **going to** + verb → he is going to do
- you, we, they <u>are</u> **going to** + verb → we are going to do

‘Going to’ is used:

- For plans and intentions
  - I**’m going to buy** a new car.
  - We **are going to visit** my sister on Monday.

- When there are signs of something happening
  - Look at the clouds. It**‘s going to rain**.
  - That vase is tipping on the edge of that shelf. It**’s going to fall** down.

Present forms to talk about the future

- In some cases you can use a present form to talk about the future
- Instead of I **'m going to do** you can also use I **am doing** when talking about plans and intentions
- Especially if you have already made the arrangements
  - We **are flying** to Australia tomorrow.
  - I **am seeing** my dentist next Tuesday
- Make sure to add a reference to the future (tomorrow, next …, etc.) to avoid confusion

Present forms to talk about the future

- The present form without -ing (I work) is not used often to talk about the future
- It is used when talking about things that are fixed in a schedule or timetable
  - The autumn break **starts** on October 20th.
  - Their plane **arrives** at 10:15

BREAK